

FREE RESOURCE · AI & FINANCE AUTOMATION

AI Prompt Library for Finance Teams

30 ready-to-use prompts for variance commentary, executive summaries, cash flow narrative, T&E analysis, and forecasting & planning.

30 prompts	5 categories	6 per category	Ready to use
------------	--------------	----------------	--------------

HOW TO USE THESE PROMPTS

Each prompt follows the **R.C.T.F. framework** — Role, Context, Task, Format. Replace all text in **[square brackets]** with your actual data before using. Paste your financial data directly into the prompt — never ask the AI to find or retrieve data. All numerical outputs should be verified against source data before use in reports.

The **Tip** at the end of each prompt explains why a specific instruction matters — these are drawn from real finance prompting experience, not theory.

CATEGORY 1 — VARIANCE COMMENTARY

PROMPTS 1–6

01 Monthly Management Report Variance Commentary

Use when: writing the management commentary section of a monthly P&L; report

You are an FP&A; analyst writing the management commentary for a monthly finance report. The audience is the CFO and two non-finance board members.

Data provided:

[PASTE YOUR ACTUAL VS BUDGET TABLE HERE]

Currency: [EUR/GBP/USD]. All figures in [thousands/millions].

Write 4–6 bullet points covering:

- The 3 largest adverse variances (by absolute value, above [€X] threshold)
- The 2 largest favourable variances
- Any variance where the cause is unclear (flag as "Requires investigation")

Do not speculate beyond what the data supports. Each bullet: max 45 words.

Format: bullet points starting with the line item name and variance amount.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Set your materiality threshold before pasting — e.g. 'only comment on variances above €25k or 8% of budget'. This prevents the model generating commentary on immaterial lines.

02 Year-to-Date Variance Summary

Use when: producing the YTD section of a quarterly board pack

You are a finance business partner preparing the year-to-date commentary for a board pack. Period: [Month] YTD.

Data:

[PASTE YTD ACTUAL VS BUDGET VS PRIOR YEAR TABLE]

Write a concise YTD summary (maximum 120 words) covering:

1. Revenue: YTD position vs budget and prior year
2. Cost: the single largest cost driver that is better or worse than budget
3. Margin: resulting margin position and what it implies for full year

Avoid the following filler phrases: "robust", "challenging environment", "headwinds", "encouraging". Be specific about what happened, not how it felt.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Specifying banned phrases forces the model to use precise language. Build your own list of finance filler words to exclude from all commentary prompts.

03 Departmental Cost Centre Commentary

Use when: writing commentary for individual cost centre owners who need to explain variances to finance

You are a finance analyst writing variance commentary for the [Department Name] cost centre for [Month/Period].

Data:

[PASTE COST CENTRE ACTUAL VS BUDGET TABLE]

The cost centre owner is [job title, e.g. Head of Operations] – non-finance background.

Write 3 bullet points explaining:

- The largest adverse variance: what happened, in plain language
- Any favourable variance worth noting
- One question the cost centre owner should be prepared to answer in the finance review

Use plain language. Avoid accounting terminology. Maximum 35 words per bullet.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Adding the audience's background ('non-finance') changes the language register significantly. Always specify who will read the output.

04 Reforecast vs Original Budget Commentary

Use when: explaining the delta between the reforecast and the original annual budget

You are preparing the commentary explaining the movement from the original budget to the current reforecast for [Full Year / H2].

Original budget: [key figures]

Current reforecast: [key figures]

Key movements: [list the 3–5 largest line changes and reasons]

Write a narrative of 100–150 words explaining:

1. The net movement at revenue, cost, and profit level
2. The 2 primary drivers of change (business reasons, not accounting mechanics)
3. Whether the reforecast represents an improvement or deterioration vs budget and why

Do not use passive voice. Write in the present tense as if presenting to the CFO.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Providing the 'key movements' list yourself prevents hallucination. The model structures and communicates — it does not discover the business reasons.

05 Flash Report Commentary (Same-Day Close)

Use when: producing rapid commentary at month-end before final numbers are confirmed

You are writing a flash report commentary for distribution by [time] on close day. Numbers are preliminary and subject to final adjustments.

Preliminary actuals:

[PASTE KEY P&L; LINES – Revenue, Gross Margin, EBITDA, key cost lines]

Prior month actuals for comparison:

[PASTE PRIOR MONTH FIGURES]

Write a 60–80 word flash summary covering:

- Revenue vs prior month (direction and approximate %)
- Margin trend
- Any unusual item flagged by the business
- Confidence level on the numbers (High / Medium / Low – your assessment based on data completeness)

Label all figures as preliminary. Do not state specific causes unless provided above.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Flash reports are read under time pressure. Specify word limits aggressively — 60 words forces prioritisation. Longer outputs defeat the purpose of a flash.

06 Investor / Lender Variance Narrative

Use when: drafting the finance narrative for an investor update or lender covenant report

You are a finance director drafting the financial performance narrative for [investor / banking partner] for the period ending [date].

Financial data:

[PASTE REVENUE, EBITDA, CASH, NET DEBT FIGURES – ACTUAL VS COVENANT / BUDGET]

Covenant thresholds (if applicable): [state thresholds]

Write a professional narrative of 180–220 words covering:

1. Overall performance vs plan – factual and direct
2. Key variances and the commercial reasons behind them
3. Covenant compliance status (if applicable)
4. Forward-looking statement for the next quarter (based only on the context provided)

Tone: professional, transparent, no marketing language. This will be read by credit analysts.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Always add 'based only on the context provided' to forward-looking sections. Without this constraint, the model will invent plausible-sounding but unsupported projections.

CATEGORY 2 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARIES

PROMPTS 7–12

07 Board Pack Executive Summary

Use when: writing the opening page of a board or steering committee pack

You are a CFO writing the executive summary for a board pack for the period [Month/Quarter].

Financial data to summarise:

[PASTE KEY P&L;, BALANCE SHEET, AND CASH FLOW HIGHLIGHTS]

Board composition: [number] members, [number] non-finance.

Write a 150–200 word executive summary covering:

1. Headline financial performance (revenue, profit, cash) vs budget
2. The single most significant positive development
3. The single most significant risk or concern
4. One decision or approval required from the board this period

Plain language throughout. No jargon. No use of: "robust", "solid", "strong performance" – be specific.

Paragraph structure, not bullet points. Suitable for a non-finance chair.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Specifying the output structure (paragraph, not bullets) matters for board packs. Board members read narratives, not lists. Match the prompt format to how the output will be used.

08 CFO Weekly Update

Use when: preparing the weekly financial update for the CEO or executive committee

You are a CFO preparing the weekly financial snapshot for the CEO. This is an internal working document – direct and concise.

Week ending: [date]

Key data points: [paste WTD revenue, cash position, key operational metric, any exception]

Prior week comparison: [paste equivalent prior week figures]

Write 4 bullet points:

1. Cash and liquidity – current position and WoW movement
2. Revenue – WTD performance and run rate implication
3. One operational signal with financial consequence
4. One item requiring CEO attention or decision

Max 20 words per bullet. No preamble. Start the first bullet immediately.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: 'No preamble. Start the first bullet immediately' eliminates the AI's tendency to open with 'Certainly! Here is the weekly update...' which wastes the reader's time.

09 Quarterly Earnings Narrative (Internal)

Use when: preparing internal commentary ahead of an external earnings call or investor day

You are the Head of Investor Relations preparing the internal narrative summary of Q[X] results for management review before the earnings call.

Q[X] actuals: [paste key financial figures]

Consensus / guidance: [paste guidance range or analyst consensus]

Performance vs guidance: [above / in line / below – and by how much]

Draft a 250-word narrative covering:

1. Headline results vs guidance
2. Revenue drivers (by segment if applicable)
3. Margin performance and explanation
4. Cash flow and balance sheet headline
5. Key message management should reinforce on the call

Factual and precise. No speculation. Flag any figure that diverges from guidance by more than [X]% with the note [EXPLAIN ON CALL].

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: The [EXPLAIN ON CALL] flag instruction teaches the model to act as an intelligent reviewer, not just a summariser. Use similar flag conventions for any output that will be edited before use.

10 Month-End Close Email to Leadership

Use when: communicating preliminary month-end results to the leadership team before the pack is circulated

You are a Finance Director writing a brief month-end results email to the [Executive Committee / SLT].

Preliminary results: [paste key P&L; lines]

Key message: [state whether this is broadly in line, ahead, or behind – and the primary reason]

Pack available: [when]

Actions required: [any]

Write a 4-sentence email (not including greeting/sign-off) that:

1. States the headline result in one sentence
2. Names the primary driver (positive or negative)
3. Notes what follows (pack, review meeting)
4. Flags one item requiring leadership attention before the review meeting

Direct tone. No filler. No caveats that dilute the message. Subject line included.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Four sentences is a strict but useful constraint for leadership emails. Anything longer gets skimmed or deferred. Use the constraint deliberately when communicating under time pressure.

11 Half-Year Results Summary

Use when: preparing the H1 performance narrative for the board, investors, or parent company reporting

You are preparing the H1 results narrative for submission to [board / parent company / investors].

H1 actuals: [paste revenue, GP, EBITDA, cash, key KPIs]

H1 budget: [paste equivalent]

H1 prior year: [paste equivalent]

Write a 200-word narrative covering:

1. H1 performance headline – actual vs budget and vs prior year
2. Revenue: primary growth or decline driver
3. Margin: what drove the improvement or deterioration
4. Cash: net movement and closing position
5. Full year outlook: directional only, based on H1 run rate

Do not extrapolate beyond what the data supports. Where the full year outlook is uncertain, say so explicitly rather than providing false confidence.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: 'Say so explicitly rather than providing false confidence' is the most important instruction for any forward-looking section. Without it, the model will produce plausible-sounding projections that have no factual basis.

12 Audit Committee Financial Summary

Use when: preparing a concise financial summary for the audit committee — a technically literate but non-operational audience

You are the CFO preparing a financial summary for the Audit Committee for [period].

Financial data: [paste key figures]

Audit / control matters to note: [list any – or state 'none this period']

Significant accounting judgements this period: [list or state 'none']

Write a 180-word summary covering:

1. Financial performance headline – factual, no marketing language
2. Any significant accounting treatment or judgement applied this period
3. Going concern: one sentence on the position
4. Any matter the Audit Committee should be aware of or that requires their approval

Use precise accounting language. Audit committee members are financially literate. Do not simplify unnecessarily.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Specifying the audience's financial literacy ('do not simplify unnecessarily') prevents the model from producing the plain-language version appropriate for a general board but insufficient for audit committee use.

CATEGORY 3 — CASH FLOW & TREASURY

PROMPTS 13–18

13 Weekly Cash Flow Narrative

Use when: writing the treasury commentary for the CFO or CEO weekly update

You are a treasury analyst writing the weekly cash flow narrative for the CFO update.

Data for week ending [date]:

Opening balance: [amount]

Operating cash inflows: [amount]

Operating cash outflows: [amount]

Investing: [amount]

Financing: [amount]

Closing balance: [amount]

Prior week closing balance: [amount]

Write a 4-sentence narrative:

1. Closing balance and net movement vs prior week
2. Largest single driver of the movement
3. Any item that deviated significantly from the prior week pattern
4. Liquidity concern if present – or omit sentence 4 if none

Do not perform calculations. Use only the figures provided. Do not use passive constructions.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: 'Do not perform calculations' is essential for cash flow prompts. The model can misread table figures and compound the error through arithmetic. All numbers should come from your data, not the model.

14 13-Week Cash Flow Forecast Commentary

Use when: preparing the narrative for a rolling 13-week cash forecast presentation

You are a treasury manager presenting the 13-week rolling cash flow forecast to [CFO / lender / board].

Forecast data:

- Opening cash: [amount]
- Forecast low point: [amount] in week [X]
- Forecast closing (week 13): [amount]
- Key inflows expected: [list with timing]
- Key outflows expected: [list with timing]
- Available facilities: [revolving credit / overdraft – limit and drawn amount]

Write a 150-word narrative covering:

1. The forecast trajectory – where cash goes and why
2. The low point week and what drives it
3. Available headroom at the low point vs facility limit
4. Any assumption that, if wrong, would materially change the forecast

Suitable for a lender covenant review. Factual, no hedging language.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Adding 'any assumption that, if wrong, would materially change the forecast' forces the model to flag sensitivity — which is exactly what a lender or CFO needs to know but what a simple summary omits.

15 Month-End Cash Flow Bridge

Use when: explaining the movement in cash from opening to closing balance at month end

You are writing the month-end cash flow bridge narrative for the finance pack.

Month-end data:

Opening cash: [amount]

Operating cash generated: [amount]

Capex paid: [amount]

Debt repaid: [amount]

Interest paid: [amount]

Other: [amount and description]

Closing cash: [amount]

Budget closing cash: [amount]

Write 3 bullet points:

1. Net movement and closing balance vs budget
2. The primary operating cash driver – positive or negative
3. Any non-recurring item and its impact on the underlying run rate

Do not invent causes. If a driver is not explained in the data provided, note 'cause not specified in data'. Maximum 40 words per bullet.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: 'If a driver is not explained in the data provided, note cause not specified' is the single most important instruction for any cash flow prompt. Without it, the model will invent plausible-sounding causes.

16 Supplier Payment Terms Analysis

Use when: preparing the commentary on creditor payment terms for a cash optimisation review

You are a working capital analyst preparing commentary on supplier payment terms for a cash flow optimisation review.

Data provided:

[PASTE SUPPLIER PAYMENT TERMS DATA – CONTRACTED DAYS, ACTUAL DAYS, SPEND BY SUPPLIER]

Write a brief analysis (150 words maximum) covering:

1. The gap between contracted and actual payment days – overall and for the top 3 suppliers by spend
2. The estimated cash impact of paying to contracted terms vs current practice
3. One recommendation for improving working capital without damaging supplier relationships

Do not make assumptions about supplier relationships or contract terms beyond what is in the data. Flag any supplier where actual days significantly exceed contracted days as a compliance risk.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Working capital analyses are compliance-sensitive. Adding 'flag as a compliance risk' instructs the model to apply a governance lens, not just a financial one.

17 Covenant Headroom Summary

Use when: preparing the covenant compliance section of a lender report

You are a finance manager preparing the covenant compliance summary for the [bank name] quarterly lender report.

Covenant details and current position:

[PASTE – Covenant name | Threshold | Current position | Headroom]

Write a compliance summary table narrative (100 words) covering:

1. Overall compliance status – all covenants met / any breach / any waiver in place
2. The covenant with least headroom – name, threshold, current position, and headroom %
3. Any covenant where the trend over the last 3 periods suggests tightening headroom
4. Forward statement on covenant compliance for the next quarter – directional only

This will be submitted to the credit team. Precise language. No marketing tone.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Covenant reports are legal documents. 'Precise language. No marketing tone' prevents the model from softening compliance concerns. Add 'do not minimise or downplay any covenant breach or near-miss' for extra safety.

18 FX Exposure Narrative

Use when: writing the foreign exchange exposure section of a treasury or board report

You are a treasury manager writing the FX exposure narrative for the [period] treasury report.

FX data:

- Functional currency: [currency]
- Primary exposure currencies: [list]
- Net exposure by currency: [paste table]
- Hedging in place: [type, notional, maturity]
- Unhedged exposure: [amount by currency]

Write a 120-word narrative covering:

1. The primary FX exposure and its origin (revenue/cost/balance sheet)
2. Current hedging coverage and maturity profile
3. The P&L; or cash impact of a [X]% adverse move in the primary exposure currency
4. Any unhedged position that requires a decision

Factual. Do not recommend hedging instruments or strategies unless specifically asked.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: 'Do not recommend instruments or strategies unless specifically asked' keeps the model in its lane. Treasury recommendations have legal and compliance implications — they should come from qualified advisors, not AI commentary.

CATEGORY 4 — EXPENSE & T&E; ANALYSIS

PROMPTS 19–24

19 Out-of-Policy Expense Analysis

Use when: producing the monthly expense compliance report for the finance controls team

You are a finance controls analyst. The table below shows expense submissions flagged as out-of-policy this month.

Policy thresholds: meals €[X] per person, accommodation €[X] per night, client entertainment €[X] per person.

[PASTE OUT-OF-POLICY SUBMISSIONS TABLE – category, country, amount, policy threshold]

Write an analysis (maximum 180 words) covering:

- 1. Total value of out-of-policy submissions and as a % of total expense spend
- 2. Category with the highest out-of-policy rate
- 3. Country with the highest out-of-policy value
- 4. Any pattern suggesting a policy communication gap rather than deliberate non-compliance
- 5. Any submission requiring escalation based on size or nature

Do not name individuals – refer by department only. Flag escalations clearly.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: 'Do not name individuals' is a data privacy requirement, not a stylistic preference. Build this into every expense analysis prompt to prevent the model including personal data in outputs.

20 T&E; Spend Category Review

Use when: reviewing monthly T&E; spend patterns for budget holders or the finance business partner

You are a finance business partner preparing the monthly T&E; spend review for [entity / region].

Spend data by category (current month and YTD):

[PASTE T&E; SPEND TABLE – category, current month actual, budget, YTD actual, YTD budget]

Write a category commentary (150 words maximum) covering:

1. Total T&E; spend vs budget – current month and YTD
2. The category most over budget – by amount and by %
3. Any category where YTD trend suggests full-year budget will be breached
4. One action recommendation for the budget holder

Avoid commentary on individual transactions. Focus on category-level patterns only.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: T&E; commentaries often reveal sensitive information about business activity. 'Focus on category-level patterns only' protects commercial confidentiality while still providing actionable insight.

21 Expense Reimbursement Timeline Analysis

Use when: assessing employee satisfaction risk from slow expense reimbursement processes

You are a finance operations analyst reviewing expense reimbursement cycle times for [entity/region].

Data:

[PASTE – submission date, approval date, payment date, amount, country, status]

Calculate and comment on (using only the data provided):

1. Average days from submission to payment – overall and by country
2. Longest outstanding claims – flag any over [X] days as a risk item
3. Any country or entity where cycle times significantly exceed the group average
4. Pattern in delayed approvals – is the bottleneck at approval stage or payment stage?

Do not perform statistical calculations beyond averages. Flag individual delays without naming the claimant.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: When asking the model to identify patterns, provide enough rows to make a pattern visible — at least 20 data points. Patterns identified from 3–5 rows are not statistically meaningful.

22 Travel Spend vs Policy Review Narrative

Use when: preparing the quarterly travel spend review comparing actuals against the travel policy

You are a travel and expense analyst preparing the quarterly travel spend review for [entity].

Policy parameters:

- Preferred carriers: [list]
- Booking advance requirement: [X days]
- Hotel policy: [max rate by city]
- Class of travel: [economy / business – by trip length]

Actual spend data:

[PASTE TRAVEL BOOKINGS TABLE – booking date, travel date, carrier/hotel, amount, policy-compliant Y/N]

Write a 200-word review covering:

1. % of bookings that are policy-compliant vs non-compliant
2. Top 3 non-compliance categories (carrier choice, advance booking, hotel rate)
3. Estimated savings if non-compliant bookings had been policy-compliant
4. Recommendation for the programme manager – training, system enforcement, or policy revision

Base the savings estimate on the data provided, not on external benchmarks.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: 'Base the savings estimate on the data provided, not on external benchmarks' prevents the model inventing industry statistics. AI fabricated benchmarks in financial reports are a liability risk.

23 Corporate Card Spend Exception Report

Use when: analysing corporate card transactions for policy exceptions or unusual patterns

You are a finance controls analyst reviewing the monthly corporate card exception report for [entity].

Exception data:

[PASTE TABLE – transaction date, merchant category, amount, cardholder department, exception type]

Exception types to analyse: weekend transactions, split transactions (potential policy avoidance), restricted merchant categories, transactions above single-transaction limit.

Write a controls summary (150 words maximum) covering:

1. Total exceptions by type and value
2. The exception category of highest value and highest frequency
3. Any pattern suggesting systematic rather than isolated non-compliance
4. 2 specific items warranting follow-up with the budget holder

Do not name cardholders. Refer to department only. This report will be reviewed by the Head of Finance and may be escalated to Internal Audit.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Stating who will review the output ('Head of Finance, may be escalated to Internal Audit') signals to the model the appropriate gravity of tone and precision required.

24 Year-End T&E; Accrual Commentary

Use when: preparing the commentary on the year-end T&E; accrual for the external audit pack

You are a finance manager preparing the T&E; accrual commentary for the year-end audit pack.

Accrual data:

- Total T&E; accrual at year-end: [amount]
- Basis of estimate: [e.g. 3 weeks of average daily spend, confirmed pending submissions]
- Average daily T&E; run rate (last 30 days): [amount]
- Confirmed pending submissions not yet processed: [amount]
- Prior year year-end accrual: [amount] / Actual outturn: [amount]

Write a technical commentary (100–130 words) suitable for the audit file covering:

1. The basis and methodology of the accrual calculation
2. Comparison to prior year accrual and actual outturn
3. Key assumption and sensitivity (if accrual is [X]% wrong, impact is [Y])
4. Management's assessment of whether the accrual is complete and reasonable

Use precise accounting language. This will be reviewed by external auditors.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Audit pack commentary requires a different register to management reports. The phrase 'suitable for the audit file' in the role description shifts the model's calibration toward technical accuracy.

CATEGORY 5 — FORECASTING & PLANNING

PROMPTS 25–30

25 Budget Challenge Meeting Preparation

Use when: preparing finance business partners for a budget challenge meeting with a budget holder

You are an FP&A; manager preparing a finance business partner for a budget challenge meeting with [department head].

Department budget submission:

[PASTE KEY LINES – headcount, salary, non-pay opex, travel, IT, other]

Prior year actuals for the same department: [paste]

Company-level constraint: [e.g. total cost base must reduce by X% or remain flat]

Prepare 5 challenge questions the finance business partner should ask in the meeting.

For each question:

- State the question
- Explain what a good answer looks like
- Note what a weak or evasive answer looks like

Focus on assumptions that are difficult to validate but material to the budget total. Do not generate generic questions – make them specific to the data provided.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: 'Do not generate generic questions — make them specific to the data provided' is one of the most useful constraints in FP&A; prompting. Without it, the model produces a list of questions that could apply to any department in any organisation.

26 Reforecast Assumption Documentation

Use when: documenting the key assumptions behind a mid-year reforecast for audit trail or governance purposes

You are an FP&A; analyst documenting the assumptions behind the [Q2/H1] reforecast for governance and audit purposes.

Reforecast changes from original budget:

[PASTE – line item, budget amount, reforecast amount, change, reason provided by business]

Write a formal assumption log entry (per line item) covering:

- What changed
- Why it changed (business reason)
- Who approved the change (role, not name)
- Level of confidence in the new estimate (High / Medium / Low)
- Key risk if the assumption proves wrong

Format as a structured table. This will be retained for audit purposes.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Asking for a table rather than prose is often more useful for governance documentation. Tables are easier to review, update, and attach to approval records than narrative paragraphs.

27 Scenario Analysis Narrative

Use when: preparing the narrative for a three-scenario analysis (base / upside / downside) for the board or investors

You are the Head of FP&A; preparing the scenario analysis narrative for the board.

Three scenarios:

Base case: [paste key P&L; lines]

Upside case: [paste key P&L; lines – key assumption: X]

Downside case: [paste key P&L; lines – key assumption: Y]

Write a 200-word narrative covering:

1. The base case headline and the primary assumption it rests on
2. What would need to be true for the upside case to materialise
3. What would trigger the downside case and its financial consequence
4. Management's recommended planning assumption and rationale

Do not express a preference between scenarios unless asked. Present the analysis objectively. Flag any scenario where an assumption is outside management's control.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: 'Do not express a preference unless asked' prevents the model from editorialising. In scenario presentations, the board decides which scenario to plan to — the finance team presents the options, not the conclusion.

28 Full Year Outlook Statement

Use when: drafting the full year outlook section of a half-year or quarterly financial report

You are a CFO drafting the full year outlook statement for the [H1 / Q3] financial report.

Current YTD performance: [paste key figures]

H2 / Q4 pipeline or forward visibility: [paste – orders, contracted revenue, confirmed cost items]

External factors relevant to the outlook: [list any – FX, inflation, market conditions]

Write a 130-word full year outlook statement covering:

1. Full year revenue expectation – directional (in line with / above / below prior guidance)
2. Margin expectation and primary driver
3. Cash generation outlook
4. One material uncertainty that could cause the outlook to vary

This statement will be included in a published financial report. Every claim must be supportable from the data provided. Do not make forward-looking statements beyond what the pipeline data supports. Flag any area of genuine uncertainty clearly.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Published outlook statements carry disclosure obligations. 'Every claim must be supportable from the data provided' is not stylistic — it is a compliance instruction. Review all AI-generated forward statements before publication.

29 KPI Dashboard Commentary

Use when: writing the commentary for a monthly KPI dashboard sent to senior leadership or the board

You are a finance manager writing the KPI dashboard commentary for [period].

KPI data:

[PASTE – KPI name, target, actual, RAG status, trend vs prior period]

Write one commentary line per KPI (maximum 20 words each) covering:

- What the metric shows
- Direction vs target (above / on track / below)
- If below target: one specific reason from the data

For KPIs rated Red:

Write an additional 2-sentence action note stating what action is underway and who owns it.

Do not generate action notes for KPIs where no action data was provided – flag these as 'Action owner TBC'.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: Dashboard commentary is read in under 60 seconds per metric. 20-word limits per KPI are strict but appropriate. Readers who want detail will ask — they do not want it in the dashboard itself.

30 Post-Investment Review Summary

Use when: preparing the financial section of a post-investment review comparing actual returns to the original business case

You are an FP&A; analyst preparing the financial section of a post-investment review for [project/investment name], [X] months post-approval.

Original business case:

[PASTE – key financial metrics promised: IRR, payback, revenue, cost savings]

Actual outturn to date:

[PASTE – equivalent metrics for the period since approval]

Write a 180-word review covering:

1. Performance vs business case – metric by metric
2. The primary reason for outperformance or underperformance
3. Timing: is the investment tracking to the original implementation timeline?
4. Revised full-return estimate based on actual trajectory, if calculable from the data

Do not calculate IRR or NPV – these require financial modelling beyond text analysis. Reference the original business case figures directly. Note any assumption in the original case that has proved incorrect.

PROMPTING TIP

Tip: 'Do not calculate IRR or NPV' prevents the model from producing fabricated financial metrics. Complex return calculations require proper financial models — the AI's role here is structure and narrative, not calculation.

ABOUT THIS RESOURCE

This prompt library was compiled by **Mirela Dragulescu**, a finance transformation specialist with 9+ years delivering finance system implementations, T&E programmes, and AI adoption initiatives across 10+ European markets. The prompts are based on real finance reporting tasks — not theoretical examples — and have been tested against actual management pack, board pack, and treasury reporting workflows.

The R.C.T.F. framework (Role, Context, Task, Format) used throughout this library is the structured prompting approach that consistently produces the most reliable outputs in financial reporting contexts. The tips are drawn from specific failure modes encountered when these prompt types were used without the relevant constraints.

WANT MORE?

The **Premium AI Prompt Library — Finance Edition** includes 150 tested prompts across 12 use cases, including FP&A automation, audit preparation, stakeholder reporting, and AI tool governance. Available at the Resources section on MD Consulting's website.

For AI implementation consulting, finance automation advisory, or T&E programme support: **MD Consulting's website** · **business.mdconsulting@gmail.com**